KSJ RESEARCH

Research Note Vol.5 · Finale

An Investment Map of AI Energy Assets

Demand → assets → listing → contracts: four volumes on one map — where to invest, where to wait, what to avoid

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Invest in contracted cash flows (CfD IRR 12.25%, PF min DSCR 1.76x), wait where deals cannot close (PPA room ≤ 17 < 40 charges, B), avoid what leans on prices or multiples (merchant IRR 3.75%)

Four volumes, four seats, seven verdicts — what separates them is less the return than the size of the assumption that flips it

Key metrics [*1,*2,*3,*4,*5]

Key metric	Value	p.
Invest · KEPCO CfD equity IRR / hurdle	**12.25% / 8%**	3
Invest · DC PF min DSCR / target	**1.76x / 1.45x**	3
CP: min DSCR if power is in the rent	0.70x	3
Wait · PPA room vs charges (B)	**KRW 5.6–17.0 vs ~KRW 40**	4
Wait · IPO required vs range discount	**37.4%–43.5% vs 21.9%–35.0%**	4
Wait · REC transitional rule (addendum art. 3, A)	former rules · notice pending	4
Avoid · merchant equity IRR	**3.75%**	5
Avoid · multiple share 3-name NI / 4-name OP	37% / 69%	5
A·D among sourceable inputs (161 in all)	**44 / 145 (30%)**	6
Corrections (git-verified)	10 (10/10)	6

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
*2 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
*3 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*4 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
*5 KSJ Research

Note: Numbers carried over from Vol.1–4 (as of 20 Oct 2026). Verdicts are judgement (J). Volume, page and grade in A2

Invest

2 assets: Solar equity on a KEPCO CfD · Data-centre PF senior loan

Contracted cash flows: KEPCO CfD equity IRR 12.25% (hurdle 8%); data-centre PF min DSCR 1.76x (target 1.45x)

- CfD equity: gearing 80% · min DSCR 1.33x — flipped by output: CF 14% → 6.6% [Vol.4 p.4 · J]
- DC PF loan KRW 188.5bn (60% of cost): condition precedent = power billed separately — if included, min DSCR 0.70x on the same debt; re-sized, equity IRR 5.7% [Vol.2 p.7 · J]

Wait

3 assets: Direct PPA with a data centre · Target Co. IPO · Existing REC-dependent assets

Returns or rules hold but the deals do not close yet: PPA room KRW 5.6–17.0 < charges ~KRW 40 (B); IPO required discount 37.4%–43.5% > the range's widest 35.0%; existing REC assets keep the former rules (addendum art. 3, A) — notice pending

- Direct PPA (IRR 13.28%): charges must fall by KRW 23 or the buyer must pay that much more — triggers: lower network charges, supply without the grid [Vol.4 p.A1 · J]
- Target Co. IPO (range KRW 66,200–79,500): required discount exceeds the range by 2.4pp–8.5pp — trigger: confirming the margin floor [Vol.3 p.7 · J]
- Existing REC assets: revenue does not vanish with the scheme (addendum art. 3(2)–(3)) — what remains is REC price and demand and the notice's scope; trigger: the notice [Vol.4 p.2 · A]

Avoid

2 assets: Merchant solar · Listed power-equipment names at ~40x P/E

They lean on market prices or multiples: merchant IRR 3.75%; multiple contribution 37%–69%

- Merchant: only at the top of the SMP range does it reach 8.2%, barely the hurdle — no RECs [Vol.4 p.4 · J]
- P/E 14.5x → 40.1x: the multiple's share is 37% on 3-name net income vs 69% on 4-name operating income [Vol.1 p.4 · D]

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44 of 145 inputs that could have a source are official or computed — all 10 corrections kept as commits

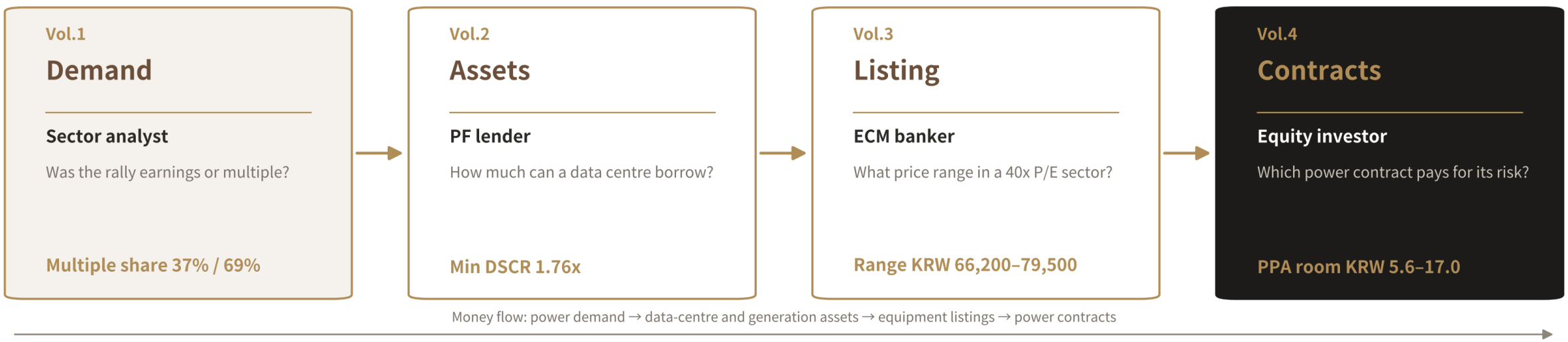
App. **Appendix** A1–A3
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Money flow and four lenses: demand (Vol.1) → assets (Vol.2) → listing (Vol.3) → contracts (Vol.4) — one industry, a different question from each seat

Sector analyst · PF lender · ECM banker · equity investor — the seat each volume took and what it concluded

The money AI power demand creates passes four turns — each with its own seat and its own decision [*1,*2,*3,*4]



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
*2 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
*3 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*4 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Number at the foot of each box = the volume's key result. Vol.1 measures demand through listed equipment caps; Vol.4 uses a hypothetical 35 MW solar plant

One-line conclusion per volume — each volume's executive-summary title, verbatim (Korean matched to its build summary 4/4) [*1,*2,*3,*4]

Vol. · stage	Seat	Question	One-line conclusion
Vol.1 · Demand	**Sector analyst**	Was the rally earnings or multiple?	Demand is real, it shows up on the ground — earnings led the market (3-name net income, 28% of starting cap; multiple-led on 4-name operating income), but P/E also rose from 14.5x to 40.1x
Vol.2 · Assets	**PF lender**	How much can a data centre borrow?	Confirming the rent definition (power included or not) is the first diligence item — Korea equity IRR 15.5% (power billed separately) / 5.7% (power included); debt capacity Korea KRW 188bn, U.S. USD 1,232mn
Vol.3 · Listing	**ECM banker**	What price range in a 40x P/E sector?	Indicative range KRW 66,200–79,500 (current basis) vs KRW 46,600–57,500 (with peak margins) — the margin floor drives the double-peak risk (FY22A 43.5% vs FY23A 37.4% median discount)
Vol.4 · Contracts	**Equity investor**	Which power contract pays for its risk?	The data centre saves 169.8 (energy rate + fuel adjustment + climate charge + fund levy) − required PPA 152.8–164.2 = room 5.6~17.0 — at most ~17 < ~40 network charges in a public example (B)

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
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Note: The same industry asks different questions from different seats — the map (p2) joins the four answers asset by asset

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The map: invest 2 · wait 3 · avoid 2 — the size of the flipping assumption matters more than the return

Base numbers as in each volume · [volume · page · grade] · verdicts and triggers are judgement (J)

Seven assets: base return · the assumption that flips it and by how much · verdict · trigger [*1,*2,*3,*4,*5]

Asset (vol. · seat)	Base return · key numbers	Assumption that flips it, and by how much	Verdict (J)	Trigger — what would change it (J)
Solar equity on a KEPCO CfD — Vol.4 · Equity investor	Equity IRR 12.25% (hurdle 8%) · gearing 80% · min DSCR 1.33x [Vol.4 p.4 · J]	Capacity factor 16% → 14% (KEEI low) cuts IRR to 6.6% < 8% [Vol.4 p.4 · J] · CAPEX at KEEI top: 8.8%	**Invest**	Re-examine if the contract-market price clears below the KRW 147.7 cap, or P90 output nears 14%
Data-centre PF senior loan — Vol.2 · PF lender	Min DSCR 1.76x (target 1.45x) · debt KRW 188.5bn (60% of cost) [Vol.2 p.3 · J]	With power inside the rent, min DSCR 0.70x on the same debt [Vol.2 p.4 · J] — re-sized, debt KRW 100.9bn, equity IRR 5.7% [Vol.2 p.7 · J]	**Invest**	Separate power billing in the lease = condition precedent to drawdown; if unconfirmed, size on the power-included basis
Direct PPA with a data centre — Vol.4 · Equity investor	Equity IRR 13.28% (corridor mid KRW 156.5) [Vol.4 p.4 · J]	Buyer's room KRW 5.6–17.0 [Vol.4 p.5 · J] vs public-example charges ~KRW 40 [Vol.4 p.5 · B] — KRW 23 short [Vol.4 p.A1]	**Wait**	Lower network charges (T&D use, settlements) · supply without the grid (notice proviso drops both items) [Vol.4 p.A4 · A]
Target Co. IPO — Vol.3 · ECM banker	Range KRW 66,200–79,500 (discount 21.9%–35.0%) [Vol.3 p.6 · J]	Margin floor FY2022A (2.9%) → required 43.5%; FY2023A (5.2%) → 37.4% [Vol.3 p.7 · J] — 2.4pp–8.5pp above the widest 35.0%	**Wait**	Confirm the margin floor: when the next results pin down the trough margin and the required discount falls inside the range (max 35.0%)
Merchant solar — Vol.4 · Equity investor	Equity IRR 3.75% (hurdle 8%) [Vol.4 p.4 · J] · no RECs for post-2027 entrants [Vol.4 p.2 · A]	Only SMP held at 148.4 (range top) lifts it to 8.2%, barely clearing [Vol.4 p.4 · J] · even at 2022 actual cost: 7.3%	Avoid	A long fixed-price contract (KEPCO market), or SMP settling at the top of its range
Existing REC-dependent assets — Vol.4 · Equity investor	No model — REC article lapses end-2029 (addendum art. 2); holders issued by the deadline and recognised licensees keep the former rules (art. 3(2)–(3)) [Vol.4 p.2 · A]	Revenue does not vanish with the scheme — what remains is REC price and demand, and the notice's scope (qualitative)	**Wait**	The ministerial notice (scope under art. 3(3), counting method under art. 4) and REC prices
Listed power-equipment names at ~40x P/E — Vol.1 · Sector analyst	3-name P/E 14.5x → 40.1x · multiple share 37% (3-name NI) / 69% (4-name OP) [Vol.1 p.4 · D]	The earnings basis decides it (37% vs 69%) · P/E 41.4x → 28.9x means −30% value on the same earnings [Vol.3 p.5 · D]	Avoid	P/E nears the normalised multiple, or earnings catch up (multiple share below 50% on 4-name operating income)

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
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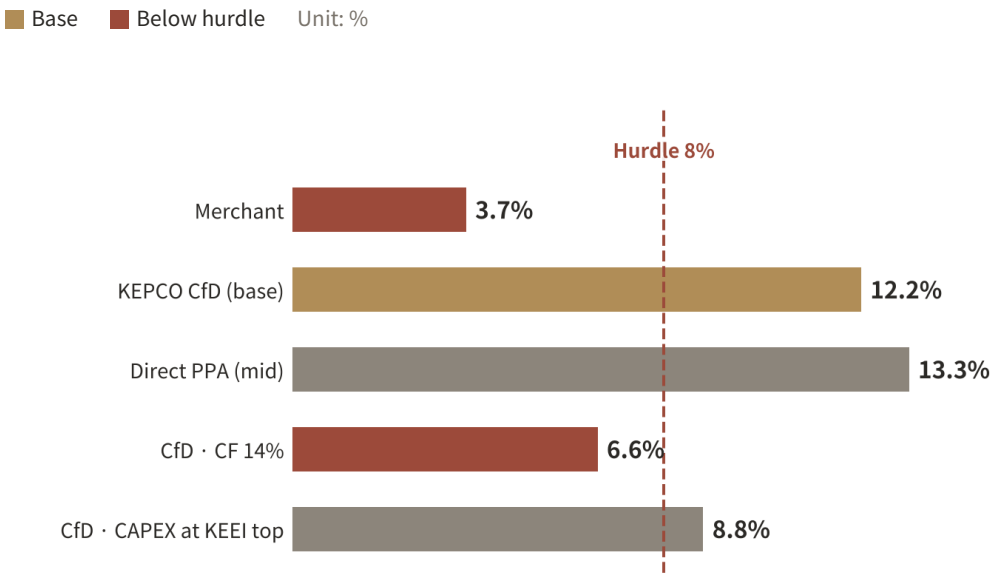
Note: Verdicts and triggers = judgement (J). Rule (J): invest = clears the hurdle or target DSCR and the flipping assumption can be managed by contract terms or CPs (incl. due diligence) · wait = returns (or statutory revenue) hold but closing conditions or a notice are still pending · avoid = misses the hurdle or leans on multiples or market prices (listed equipment: multiple share > 50% on 4-name operating income). [volume · page · grade]: grade = weakest grade among the main inputs (A official > D computed from official > B press/external > C secondary > J judgement); computed values at least D — A2

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Invest: KEPCO CfD equity (IRR 12.25%) · data-centre PF senior loan (min DSCR 1.76x) — contracted cash flows

2 conditions: output for the CfD (P90 study); separate power billing for the PF loan (CP to drawdown)

KEPCO CfD equity IRR 12.25% clears the 8% hurdle — but a 14% capacity factor cuts it to 6.6% *1



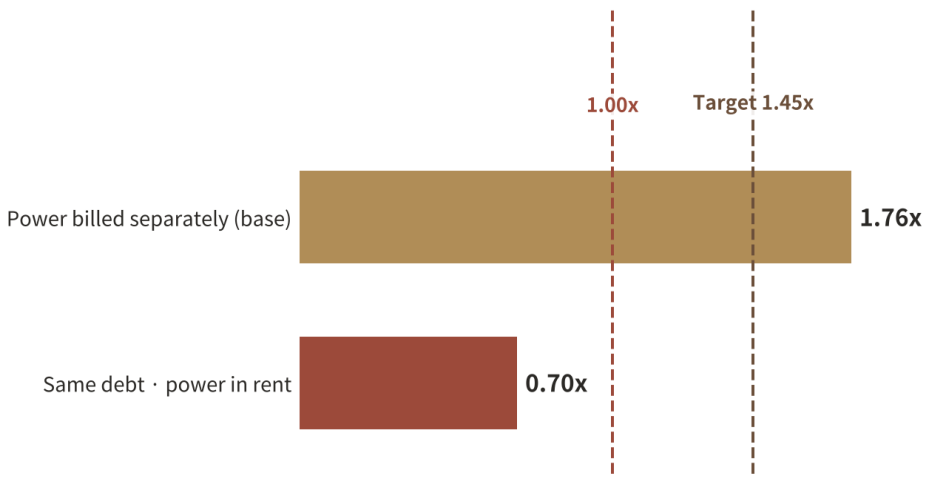
Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Vol.4 p.4 equity IRR and one-at-a-time sensitivities [Vol.4 p.4 · J]. CF range = KEEI (A); CAPEX top = fitted to the KEEI LCOE top

Why invest: revenue under a 20-year KEPCO contract — 80% gearing still leaves min DSCR 1.33x (target 1.20x) *1

Item	Value	Source	Grade
Equity IRR · KEPCO CfD	12.25%	Vol.4 p.4	J
Equity hurdle	8%	Vol.4 p.4	J
Gearing · KEPCO CfD	80%	Vol.4 p.4	J
Min DSCR · KEPCO CfD	1.33x	Vol.4 p.4	J
Target DSCR · KEPCO CfD	1.20x	Vol.4 p.2	J
KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap)	KRW 147.7	Vol.4 p.3	J
Capacity factor (base)	16%	Vol.4 p.1	A
KEPCO CfD equity IRR · CF at range low	CF 14% → 6.6%	Vol.4 p.4	J
KEPCO CfD equity IRR · CAPEX at KEEI top	8.8%	Vol.4 p.4	J

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Conditions (J): fix gearing after a P90 resource study · recompute if the auction clears below the cap. KEPCO price (J) = the 2026 cap as a proxy for the 2027 market

Data-centre PF min DSCR 1.76x — with power inside the rent, 0.70x on the same debt *1



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
Note: Vol.2 Korean 40 MW case A — base [Vol.2 p.3 · J], power-included stress [Vol.2 p.4 · J]. Target DSCR is judgement (J)

Condition precedent: power billed separately in the lease — otherwise capacity KRW 100.9bn, equity IRR 5.7% *1

Item	Value	Source	Grade
Debt capacity	KRW 188.5bn	Vol.2 p.3	J
Gearing (of total cost)	60%	Vol.2 p.3	J
Min DSCR (power billed separately)	1.76x	Vol.2 p.3	J
Target DSCR (sizing)	1.45x	Vol.2 p.3	J
Equity IRR · power billed separately	15.5%	Vol.2 p.7	J
Min DSCR · same debt, power in rent	0.70x	Vol.2 p.4	J
Debt capacity · re-sized with power in rent	KRW 100.9bn	Vol.2 p.7	J
Equity IRR · power included in rent	5.7%	Vol.2 p.7	J

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
Note: Lender's view: contracted rent services the debt — if power sits inside the rent, part of it flows to KEPCO and DSCR drops below 1x

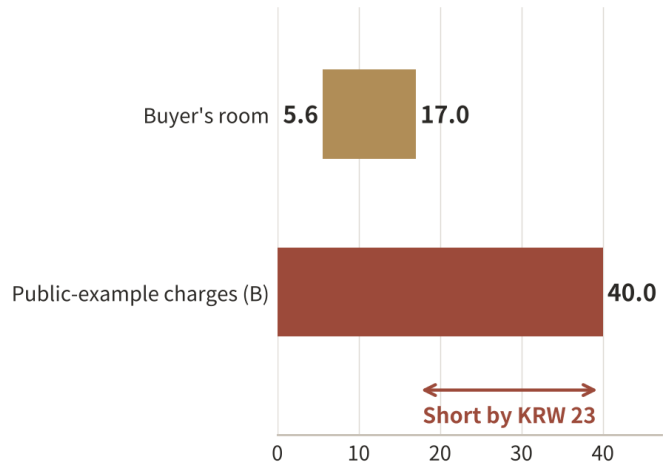
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Wait: direct PPA (IRR 13.28%, room 17 < 40) · Target Co. IPO (required 37.4%–43.5%) · REC-dependent assets (former rules kept, notice pending) — not the return, the closing conditions

Triggers move them to invest: network charges for the PPA; the margin floor for the IPO; the ministerial notice for REC assets

Direct PPA: buyer's room KRW 5.6–17.0 < public-example charges ~KRW 40 (B) — KRW 23 short [*1]

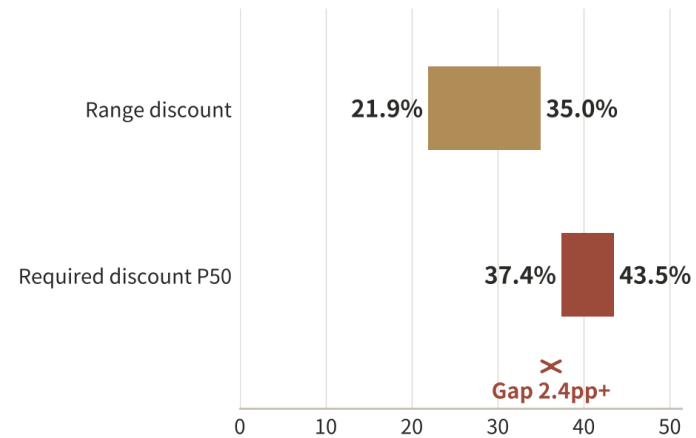
Unit: KRW/kWh



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Vol.4 p.5 [Vol.4 p.5 · J] · charges = KEPCO-brokered third-party PPA, solar Case 1 (SFOC 2021) [Vol.4 p.5 · B] — direct-PPA charges may be lower (Vol.4 A4)

Target Co. IPO: required discount 37.4%–43.5% > range discount 21.9%–35.0% — the range is high until the margin floor is known [*1]

Unit: %



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
Note: Vol.3 p.6 range [Vol.3 p.6 · J] · p.7 double-peak (triangular margin) Monte Carlo [Vol.3 p.7 · J]. Gap 2.4pp–8.5pp

Existing REC-dependent assets: existing holders and recognised licensees keep the former rules (addendum art. 3(2)–(3), A) — wait for the notice [*1]

- The REC article (12-7) stays in force to end-2029; the issuance deadline is 31 Dec 2026 (RE Act addendum arts. 2, 3(1)) [Vol.4 p.2 · A]
- Holders issued RECs by the deadline keep issuing and trading under the former rules, as do pre-act licensees recognised by ministerial notice (addendum art. 3(2)–(3)) — 'the scheme ends, so the revenue goes' does not hold [Vol.4 p.2 · A]
- What remains (J): REC price and demand, and the notice's scope — even counting excess RECs toward targets (addendum art. 4) awaits a notice. Qualitative, no model
- Trigger (J): the ministerial notice (scope under art. 3(3), counting method under art. 4) and REC prices — then value the asset from remaining issuance years and REC revenue share

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity

Triggers: lower network charges · supply without the grid — no grid use drops T&D and settlement charges (notice proviso, A) [*1]

Item	Value	Source	Grade
Equity IRR · direct PPA	13.28%	Vol.4 p.4	J
Direct PPA price (corridor mid)	KRW 156.5	Vol.4 p.4	J
Seller's required PPA price (per kWh)	KRW 152.8–164.2	Vol.4 p.i	J
Buyer's room for network charges (per kWh)	**KRW 5.6–17.0**	Vol.4 p.5	J
Public example of charges (KEPCO-brokered 3rd-party PPA)	~KRW 40	Vol.4 p.5	B
Charge cut (or buyer premium) needed to close	**KRW 23**	Vol.4 p.A1	J

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Notice proviso: items 2 and 4 drop out if the T&D grid is not used [Vol.4 p.A4 · A]. Line that changes the verdict (J): charges ≤ the buyer's maximum room 17.0

Trigger: confirm the margin floor — when the next results pin down the trough and the required discount falls inside the range [*1]

Item	Value	Source	Grade
Indicative range (current basis)	KRW 66,200–79,500	Vol.3 p.6	J
Value per share	KRW 101,810	Vol.3 p.6	J
Range discount (to value)	21.9%–35.0%	Vol.3 p.A2	D
3-name net margin FY2025A	10.3%	Vol.3 p.2	D
Net-margin floor FY2022A / FY2023A	2.9% / 5.2%	Vol.3 p.7	D
Required discount P50 · margin floor FY2022A (2.9%)	**43.5%**	Vol.3 p.7	J
Required discount P50 · margin floor FY2023A (5.2%)	**37.4%**	Vol.3 p.7	J

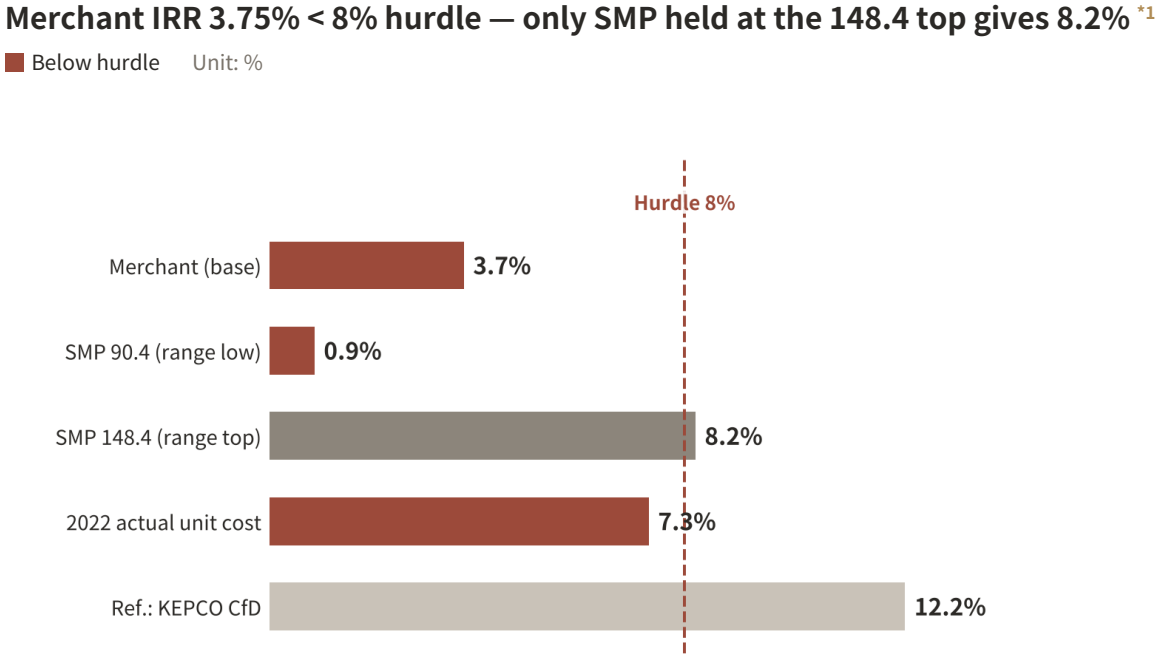
Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
Note: ECM view (J): before cutting the range, evidence the margin floor (backlog, pricing power) — even an FY2023A floor leaves a gap

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Avoid: merchant (IRR 3.75%) · chasing ~40x P/E (multiple share 37%–69%) — returns hang on prices no contract can fix

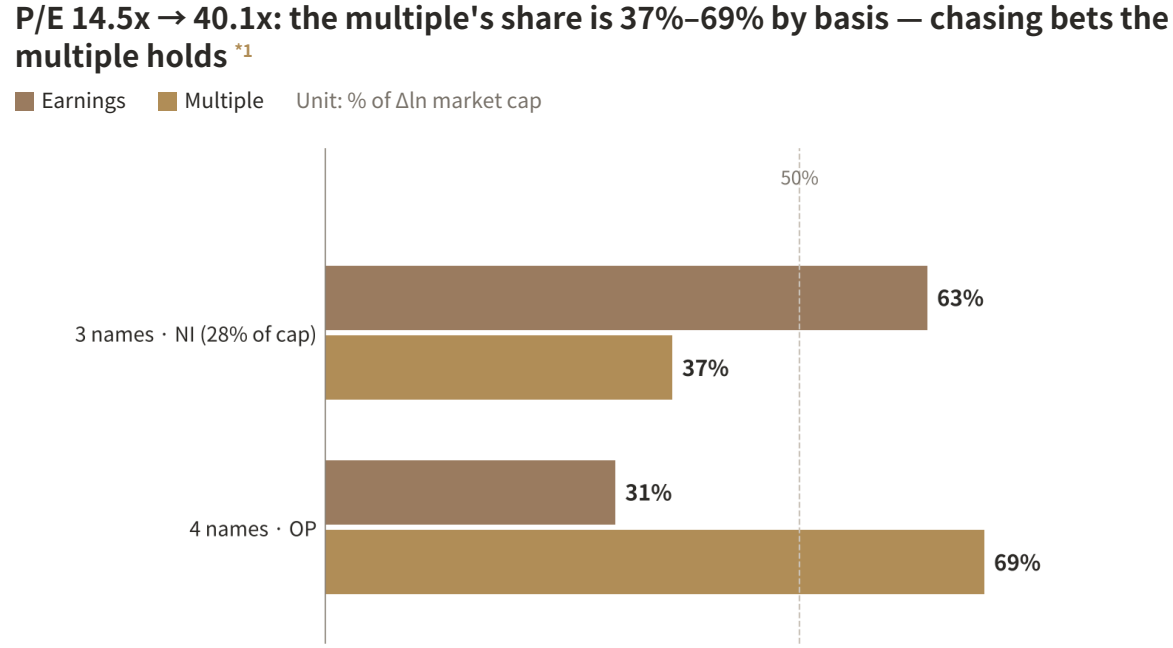
Common thread: returns hang on prices no contract can fix (SMP, multiples)

Merchant IRR 3.75% < 8% hurdle — only SMP held at the 148.4 top gives 8.2% *1



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Vol.4 p.4 [Vol.4 p.4 · J] · SMP range = EPSIS 12-month mainland (A) · no RECs for post-2027 entrants [Vol.4 p.2 · A]

P/E 14.5x → 40.1x: the multiple's share is 37%–69% by basis — chasing bets the multiple holds *1



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
Note: Vol.1 p.4 [Vol.1 p.4 · D] — Doosan Enerbility (FY2022A net loss) cannot be split on net income. Normalised P/E [Vol.3 p.5 · D]

Why avoid, and what would bring them back — all 2 lean on prices nobody can contract *1,*2,*3

Asset	Why avoid	Signal to revisit (J)
Merchant solar	IRR 3.75% < 8%, no RECs	A long fixed-price contract
Listed power-equipment names at ~40x P/E	Multiple share 37%–69% · −30% if normalised	P/E near the normalised 28.9x

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
*2 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*3 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: Avoid = not at today's price, not never (J). Listed names are a sector-level view, not a call on any stock

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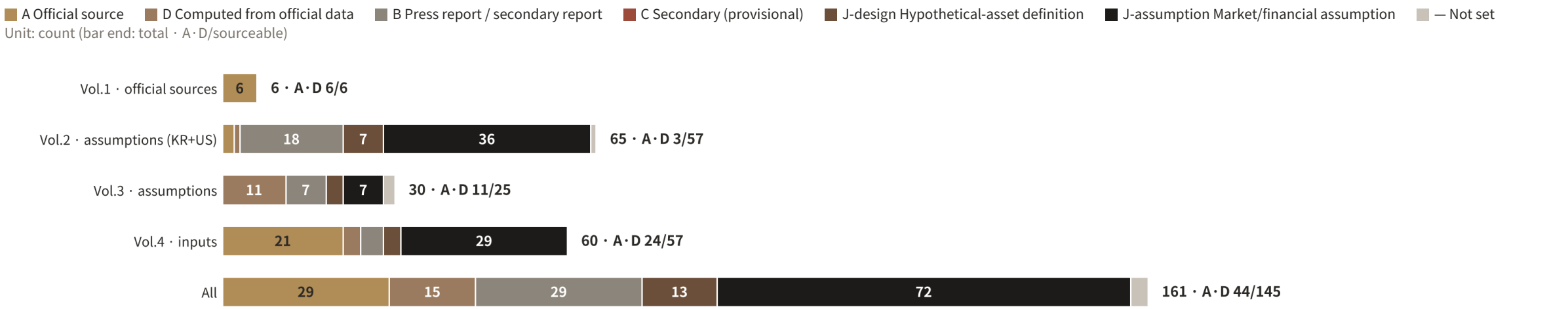
Corrections by volume (git and build summaries, before → after) · source grades of Vol.1–4 inputs (J split into definitions and assumptions)

10 corrections: independent reviews after publishing found assumptions that changed conclusions — kept on record, before → after (git check 10/10) *1

Vol.	Commit · date	What changed	Before	After	git check
Vol.1	ba39c97 · 2026-10-24	Scope of the 'earnings-led' verdict	61% of the gain is earnings (3-name basis only)	3-name NI: earnings 61% (28% of starting cap) · 4-name OP: multiple 69%	match
Vol.2	67666f4 · 2026-10-22	Base-case power definition (to pass-through), sourced CAPEX	Base = power included: debt KRW 100.9bn · IRR 7.1% (18.7% if billed separately)	Base = billed separately: debt KRW 204.9bn · IRR 16.1% vs 5.7% with power included	match
Vol.2	a85e0d7·ef6d17a · 2026-10-24	Gearing cap on CAPEX only	Debt KRW 204.9bn (65%) · min DSCR 1.63x · IRR 16.1%	Debt KRW 188.5bn (60%) · min DSCR 1.76x · IRR 15.5%	match
Vol.3	5985ffc · 2026-10-22	Double-peak (peak-margin) risk added	Range KRW 79,500–89,400 (16–25% discount)	Peak-margin range KRW 46,900–57,600 shown alongside	match
Vol.3	9e33886 · 2026-10-23	Discount defined as 1 − range ÷ value	Range KRW 67,600–80,400	Range KRW 66,200–79,500	match
Vol.3	7acc942 · 2026-10-24	What the double-peak verdict depends on	The discount alone cannot cover the double peak	Margin floor decides: 43.4% required at FY2022A · 37.9% at FY2023A	match
Vol.4	a90eb3a · 2026-10-24	Buyer ceiling = solar-hour avoided rate	Average tariff 181.9 · room KRW 18–29	Avoided rate 151.3 · room −12.9 to −1.4 (closed before charges)	match
Vol.4	5bb4cdd·5f599aa · 2026-10-24	Ceiling in 3 stages (+fuel adj. +climate charge)	Ceiling 151.3 · room −12.9 to −1.4 · PPA IRR 11.6%	Ceiling 165.3 · room 1.1–12.6 · PPA IRR 13.3%	match
Vol.4	90a9223 · 2026-10-24	Fund levy on a like-for-like basis with the 40 example	Room 1.1–12.6 (levy not matched)	Room basis 169.8 · room 5.6–17.0	match
Vol.5	5d61216 · 2026-10-29	Legacy REC verdict basis: press report → statute original	Avoid — REC spot market until end-2029 (press, B); transitional rules unchecked	Wait — REC article lapses end-2029; existing holders and recognised licensees keep the former rules (RE Act addendum art. 3(2)–(3), A)	match

Source: *1 Repository git history (commit hashes) · each volume's build summary before/after
Note: git check = code confirms the 'before' text leaves and the 'after' text appears in the volume's build summary between the first commit's parent and the last commit. Numbers are as published at each point

161 inputs: A 29 · D 15 · B 29 · C 0 · J-design 13 · J-assumption 72 · not set 3 — excluding hypothetical-asset definitions, 145 inputs could have a source; J-assumption is 50% of them, hence a flipping assumption on every verdict *1,*2,*3,*4



Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
*2 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
*3 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*4 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity

Note: Counted in code. Vol.4 = grades in its input file · Vol.1 = official raw-data sources (filings, public bodies, IEA) A · Vol.2–3 = assumption status mapped (data/evidence → D, sourced → A if an official domain else B, verify → B, judgement/neutral → J-assumption, design → J-design). J-design = values that define the hypothetical asset, company or deal (size, timing, structure; Vol.4: 'author's design' in the source field) — no source can exist, so excluded from the base. Base = inputs with a value − J-design. Mapping rules are judgement (J)

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IC memo: conditional yes on 2 assets — P90 study for the CfD equity, separate power billing for the PF loan; the rest wait for triggers

Recommendation · key risks · CPs · monitoring (illustrative — hypothetical assets and company)

Recommendation (judgement, J) *1

Asset	Verdict	Recommendation
Solar equity on a KEPCO CfD	Invest	Invest as the base case — fix gearing after a P90 resource study
Data-centre PF senior loan	Invest	Approve — separate power billing as a CP to drawdown
Direct PPA with a data centre	Wait	Hold — resubmit once charges and the buyer's RE100 premium are confirmed
Target Co. IPO	Wait	Hold the range — re-price once the margin floor is evidenced
Merchant solar	Avoid	Do not invest — misses the hurdle without a long contract
Existing REC-dependent assets	Wait	Hold — check licence date and recognition; resubmit once the notice is out
Listed power-equipment names at ~40x P/E	Avoid	Do not chase — revisit near the normalised multiple

Source: *1 KSJ Research

Key risks, in numbers *1,*2,*3,*4

Risk	Impact	Source
Lower output	CF 14% → 6.6%	[Vol.4 p.4]
Power inside the rent	Min DSCR 0.70x on the same debt	[Vol.2 p.4]
Charges > buyer's room	KRW 5.6–17.0 vs ~KRW 40	[Vol.4 p.5]
Peak margins (double peak)	Required discount 43.5%	[Vol.3 p.7]
SMP fall	SMP 90.4 → 0.9%	[Vol.4 p.4]
REC prices, scope of the notice	Former rules kept (art. 3(2)–(3)) — scope and method await a notice	[Vol.4 p.2]
Multiple normalises	P/E 41.4x → 28.9x → value −30%	[Vol.3 p.5]

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
*2 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
*3 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*4 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity

Conditions precedent (CP) *1,*2,*3

Condition	Applies to	Basis
Separate power billing in the lease	Data-centre PF senior loan	[Vol.2 p.7]
P90 resource study (CF above 14%)	Solar equity on a KEPCO CfD	[Vol.4 p.4]
Auction clearing price (assumed KRW 147.7)	Solar equity on a KEPCO CfD	[Vol.4 p.3]
Buyer's all-in price at current T&D and settlement rates	Direct PPA with a data centre	[Vol.4 p.A1]
Termination payment, parent guarantee	Direct PPA with a data centre	[Vol.4 p.A1]
Next results: net-margin floor	Target Co. IPO	[Vol.3 p.7]
REC issuance before 31 Dec 2026, pre-act licence, recognition by notice	Existing REC-dependent assets	[Vol.4 p.2]

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
*2 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*3 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity

Monitoring — levels that change a verdict (J) *1,*2

Indicator	Now	Level that changes it (J)
KEPCO contract-market price	KRW 147.7	Below the cap → recompute CfD IRR
Direct-PPA charges	~KRW 40	≤ 17.0 → PPA closes
SMP (12-month mainland)	KRW 113.2	Sustained ≥ 148.4 → revisit merchant
3-name net margin	10.3%	A floor that brings the required discount to ≤ 35.0% — even FY2023A 5.2% gives 37.4%
Equipment P/E	41.4x	Near the normalised 28.9x → revisit
KTB 3-yr	3.84% (2026-10-20)	Rate moves → recompute CfD and PF
REC transitional notice, REC prices	Act (A), notice pending	Notice issued (scope, art. 4 method) and prices → re-assess existing assets

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.3 (Oct 2026) — Target Co. price range
*2 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity
Note: 'Now' = each volume's as-of date (20 Oct 2026). Levels come from the volumes; using them as verdict lines is judgement

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Source map: every result traced to its volume, page and source grade

Values loaded from each volume's calculation (as of 20 Oct 2026) — no invented numbers

46 results → volume, page, grade: page check 46/46 · build-summary check 28/28 *1,*2,*3,*4

Result	Value	Source	Grade (weakest input)	Check
Multiple contribution · 3-name net income	37%	Vol.1 p.4	D	O O
Earnings contribution · 3-name net income	63%	Vol.1 p.4	D	O O
3-name split's share of starting cap	28%	Vol.1 p.4	D	O O
Multiple contribution · 4-name operating income	69%	Vol.1 p.4	D	O O
3-name P/E (start-2023 → now)	14.5x → 40.1x	Vol.1 p.4	D	O O
Min DSCR (power billed separately)	1.76x	Vol.2 p.3	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O O
Target DSCR (sizing)	1.45x	Vol.2 p.3	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O ·
Debt capacity	KRW 188.5bn	Vol.2 p.3	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O O
Gearing (of total cost)	60%	Vol.2 p.3	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O O
Equity IRR · power billed separately	15.5%	Vol.2 p.7	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O O
Equity IRR · power included in rent	5.7%	Vol.2 p.7	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O O
Debt capacity · re-sized with power in rent	KRW 100.9bn	Vol.2 p.7	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O O
Min DSCR · same debt, power in rent	0.70x	Vol.2 p.4	**J (Target DSCR (Korea))**	O ·
Indicative range (current basis)	KRW 66,200–79,500	Vol.3 p.6	**J (Revenue FY2025A)**	O O
Range discount (to value)	21.9%–35.0%	Vol.3 p.A2	D	O O
Value per share	KRW 101,810	Vol.3 p.6	**J (Revenue FY2025A)**	O O
Required discount P50 · margin floor FY2022A (2.9%)	43.5%	Vol.3 p.7	**J (1-yr net margin distribution)**	O O
Required discount P50 · margin floor FY2023A (5.2%)	37.4%	Vol.3 p.7	**J (1-yr net margin distribution)**	O O
Net-margin floor FY2022A / FY2023A	2.9% / 5.2%	Vol.3 p.7	D	O ·
3-name net margin FY2025A	10.3%	Vol.3 p.2	D	O ·
Applied P/E → normalised P/E	41.4x → 28.9x	Vol.3 p.5	D	O O
Equity hurdle	8%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (Equity hurdle)**	O ·
Equity IRR · KEPCO CfD	12.25%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O O

Grades: A official · D computed from official · B press/external · C secondary · J judgement

Result	Value	Source	Grade (weakest input)	Check
Equity IRR · direct PPA	13.28%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O O
Equity IRR · merchant	3.75%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (Max gearing · merchant)**	O O
Gearing · KEPCO CfD	80%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O O
Min DSCR · KEPCO CfD	1.33x	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O O
Target DSCR · KEPCO CfD	1.20x	Vol.4 p.2	**J (Target DSCR · CfD)**	O ·
KEPCO CfD equity IRR · CF at range low	CF 14% → 6.6%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O ·
Capacity factor (base)	16%	Vol.4 p.1	A	O O
KEPCO CfD equity IRR · CAPEX at KEEI top	8.8%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O ·
Merchant equity IRR · SMP at range top	SMP 148.4 → 8.2%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (Max gearing · merchant)**	O ·
Merchant equity IRR · SMP at range low	SMP 90.4 → 0.9%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (Max gearing · merchant)**	O ·
SMP base (12-month mainland average)	KRW 113.2	Vol.4 p.3	A	O ·
KTB 3-yr	3.84% (2026-10-20)	Vol.4 p.A4	A	O ·
Merchant equity IRR · 2022 actual unit cost	7.3%	Vol.4 p.4	**J (Max gearing · merchant)**	O O
KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap)	KRW 147.7	Vol.4 p.3	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O ·
Direct PPA price (corridor mid)	KRW 156.5	Vol.4 p.4	**J (KEPCO contract price (2026 round-1 cap))**	O O
Buyer's room for network charges (per kWh)	KRW 5.6–17.0	Vol.4 p.5	**J (Daily output shape exponent)**	O O
Seller's required PPA price (per kWh)	KRW 152.8–164.2	Vol.4 p.i	**J (Daily output shape exponent)**	O O
Public example of charges (KEPCO-brokered 3rd-party PPA)	~KRW 40	Vol.4 p.5	B	O O
Charge cut (or buyer premium) needed to close	KRW 23	Vol.4 p.A1	**J (Daily output shape exponent)**	O ·
Direct-PPA notice proviso (no grid use)	items 2 and 4 drop out if the T&D grid is not used	Vol.4 p.A4	A	O ·
REC article lapses (RE Act addendum art. 2)	end-2029	Vol.4 p.2	A	O ·
Transitional rule for existing REC holders and recognised licensees (addendum art. 3(2)–(3))	former rules kept	Vol.4 p.2	A	O ·
REC revenue for post-2027 entrants	no RECs	Vol.4 p.2	A	O ·

Source: *1 KSJ Research Vol.1 (Oct 2026) — DART/KRX market-cap split
*2 KSJ Research Vol.2 (Oct 2026) — Korean 40 MW data-centre PF
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*4 KSJ Research Vol.4 (Oct 2026) — hypothetical 35 MW solar equity

Note: Check: first O = the same value appears on that page of the volume (Korean text); second O = also in the volume's build summary (· = not applicable). Both verified in code at build. The page may show a rounded figure (e.g. 12.25% → 12.2%; exact values in the build summary). Grade = weakest main input (computed values at least D); brackets name that input

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Glossary: the words on the map

Prices KRW/kWh · amounts KRW 100mn · ratios % · multiples x

Glossary

Term	Definition
Invest · wait · avoid	The three verdicts (judgement, J), set by return, closing conditions and flipping assumptions (rule on p2)
Trigger	An observable signal that would change a verdict (judgement)
Flipping assumption	The input, and the move in it, that changes the conclusion — from each volume's sensitivities
Source grade	A official · D computed from official data · B press/external report · C secondary (provisional) · J judgement
CfD	Contract for difference with KEPCO; from 2027 the default for new solar
PPA	Power purchase agreement — seller and buyer fix price, term and volume directly
SMP · REC	System marginal price (wholesale power) · renewable certificate (issuance deadline 31 Dec 2026; existing holders and recognised licensees keep the former rules — RE Act addendum art. 3)
DSCR	Debt service coverage = cash flow available ÷ debt service; lenders watch the minimum against a target
Condition precedent (CP)	A condition to be met before drawdown or closing
Equity IRR · hurdle	Return on equity · minimum return required (judgement in Vol.4)
Price range · discount	IPO price range · 1 − range ÷ value per share
Double peak · required discount	Risk that earnings and multiples peak together · discount needed to avoid a loss in the 1-year value distribution (P50)
Multiple contribution	Share of Δln(cap) due to Δln(P/E) — depends on the earnings basis (NI or OP)
Network and ancillary charges	T&D use charges, trading fee, settlements and fund levy a direct-PPA buyer pays

Note: Shaded = terms new in this volume; the rest match the Vol.1–4 glossaries

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Afterword

This series began with a single question: "If AI uses this much electricity, where does the money flow, and what does finance have to decide at each turn along the way?"

I studied in the Division of Environmental Science and Ecological Engineering at Korea University, and I am now studying energy and climate at the KAIST Graduate School of Green Growth and Sustainability. The more I studied, the more I found myself curious not about the technology itself but about how it actually gets built. Even with good technology and good policy, nothing gets built unless capital moves. I wanted to understand how projects raise money and how they are structured to earn a return, so I have studied finance on the side.

As an undergraduate I sought out courses in the Department of Food and Resource Economics, and at KAIST I learned accounting principles and climate finance, estimating the cash flows of a biochar plant with financial-engineering methods. In a Hanwha finance competition I priced a product built on a barrier-option structure, and in a project with the ECM division of iM Securities I practised putting what I had learned into the language of practice. This series is the first time I have tried to weave those separate threads of study together on a single industry.

Across the four volumes I tried to sit in a different seat each time. As a sector analyst I took apart a rise in share prices; as a PF lender I set a loan limit; as an ECM banker I drew an IPO price range; and as an equity investor I weighed the price of a power contract. The same industry raised different questions depending on where I sat, and I learned that judgement only becomes solid when those questions are joined together.

I took particular care with the numbers. Every input carries a source and a reliability grade, and I went back to the tariff tables and official notices themselves to check them line by line. After publishing, independent reviews still found assumptions that changed conclusions; I corrected them and kept the corrections on the record rather than hiding them. AI helped me write the code, but deciding what to ask, and checking whether the numbers could be trusted, remained my job to the end.

Even so, this is work I studied and estimated on my own, in the gaps between preparing to graduate and looking for a job. It is an exercise built on public information and assumptions, and to a practitioner's eye it will fall short in many places. I also know that a real deal holds far more: a single clause in a contract, the mood at the negotiating table, risks that numbers do not capture. If you point out where it falls short, I will be grateful to learn from it.

Looking back, I have always tried not to let go of my dreams. While I crossed the boundaries of my major to study finance, there were days when I asked myself whether I had been chasing ideals too much. Honestly, I am not yet sure that I can settle in and grow well as a finance professional. Still, one thing became clear as I finished this series: all that is left now is to move forward.

I want to keep practising the approach of this series. Looking at the same asset, I will think about how someone who manages capital would protect its value, and on what terms someone who entrusts capital would commit it. I will also ask what someone who spots new business opportunities early would look for, and what someone who sets an investment strategy to grow value would change. I believe the starting point for all of this is structuring deals and designing how they are financed. Wherever I sit, my goal is to become a finance professional who judges energy and infrastructure assets through numbers and can explain the basis for that judgement all the way through.

I leave this series not as a finished piece but as the starting point of that path. After my master's, I will hold on to these questions and keep studying.

Thank you to everyone who has read this series.

With gratitude, Shinjae Kang

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- Invest / wait / avoid verdicts and triggers are the author's judgement (J). Numbers are carried over from Vol.1–4 with their volume, page and source grade (A2).
- Target Co., the 35 MW solar asset and the data centres are hypothetical. Listed power-equipment names are discussed at sector level, not as a view on any stock.
- Views are the author's own and do not represent any current or future employer.
- Vol.5 as of 2026-10-28 (Vol.1–4 numbers keep their own as-of dates). Methods and code can be reproduced from the repository.
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https://github.com/Cojae-Kang/ksj-ai-energy-asset-portfolio

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